

Zoho Creator Platform Overview

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1. Platform Overview

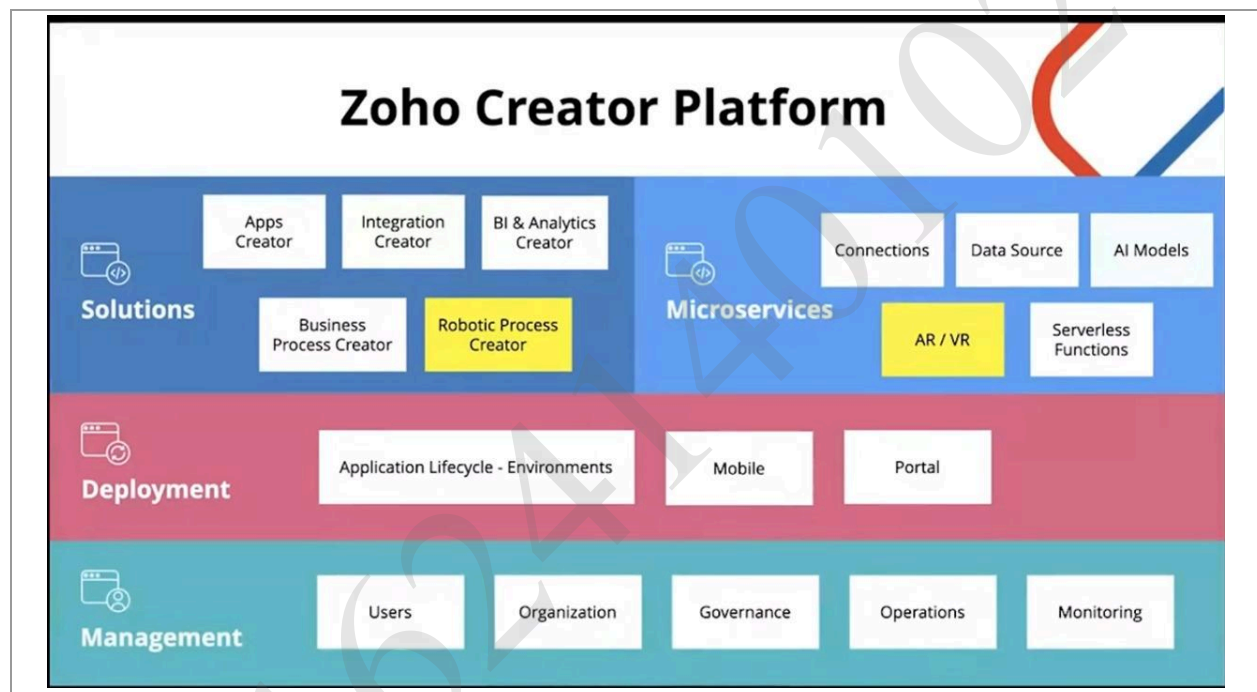


Figure 1. Zoho Creator platform landing view.

- Zoho Creator is a low-code application development platform used to build custom business applications quickly.
- It provides features such as application development, workflow automation, database management, integrations, and analytics.
- The platform allows users to create forms, reports, dashboards, and automated processes with minimal coding.
- It supports deployment across web and mobile platforms for easy access.
- In this project, Zoho Creator is used to develop the Student Leave Management System with automated workflows and data management.

2. Application Dashboard

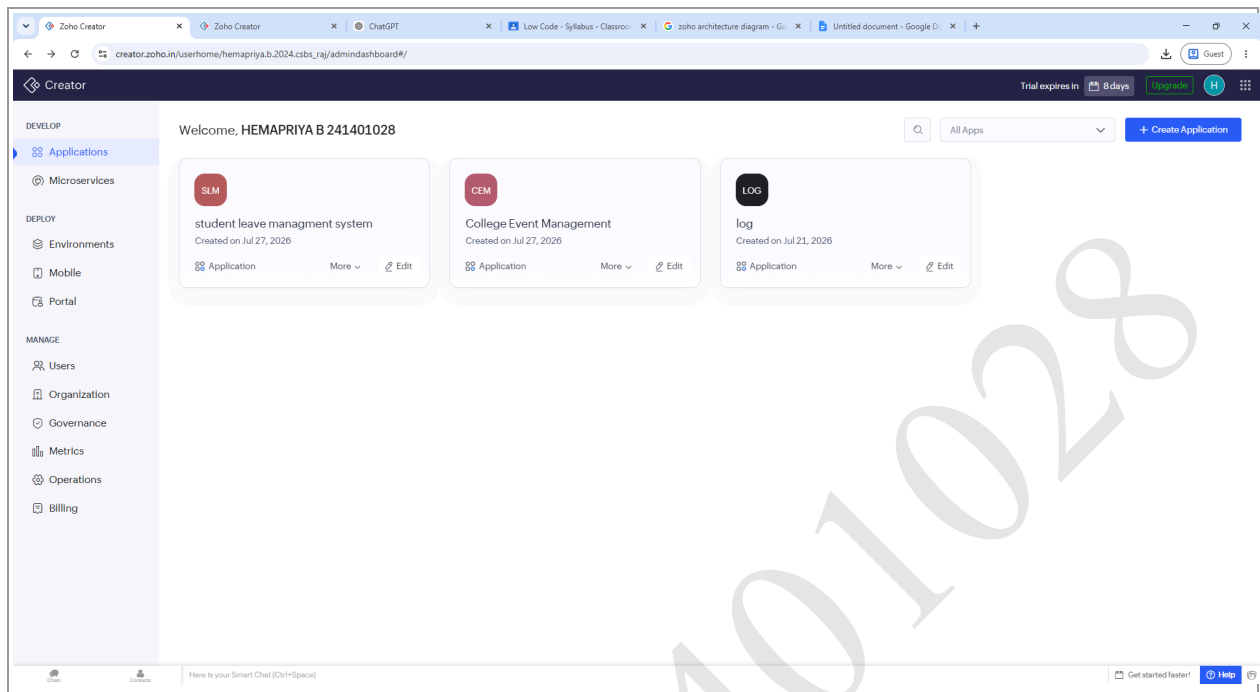


Figure 2. Application dashboard showing developed apps.

- The Zoho Creator dashboard displays the developed applications available in the workspace.
- The Student Leave Management System application is created and managed through this dashboard.
- It provides options to edit, deploy, and manage application components.
- The platform simplifies application development through drag-and-drop features and automation.
- The system can be extended with workflows, reports, and user management features.

3. Environments

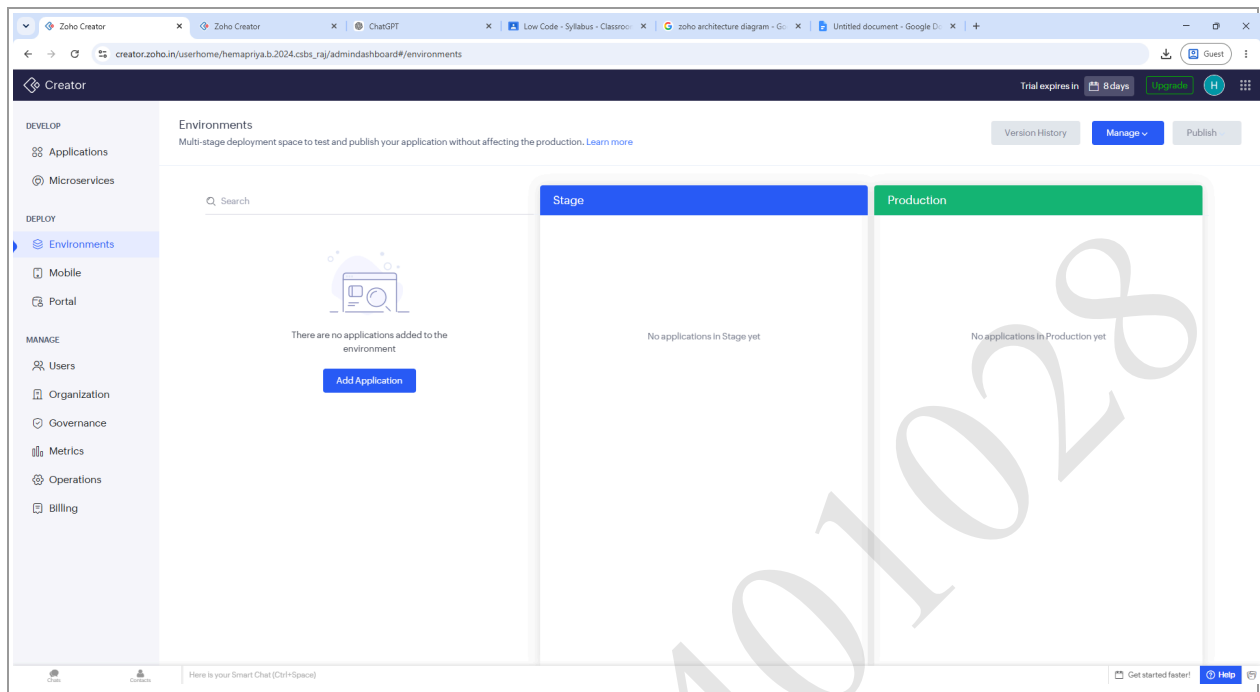


Figure 3. Environment configuration for Dev, QA, and Production.

- Manages isolated workspaces for Dev, QA, and Production stages.
- Displays environment-specific settings, data sources, and integration endpoints.
- Allows cloning of environments to replicate configurations for testing.
- Restricts access to environments based on user roles and permissions.
- Separates experimental changes from live production data to reduce risk.

4. Mobile

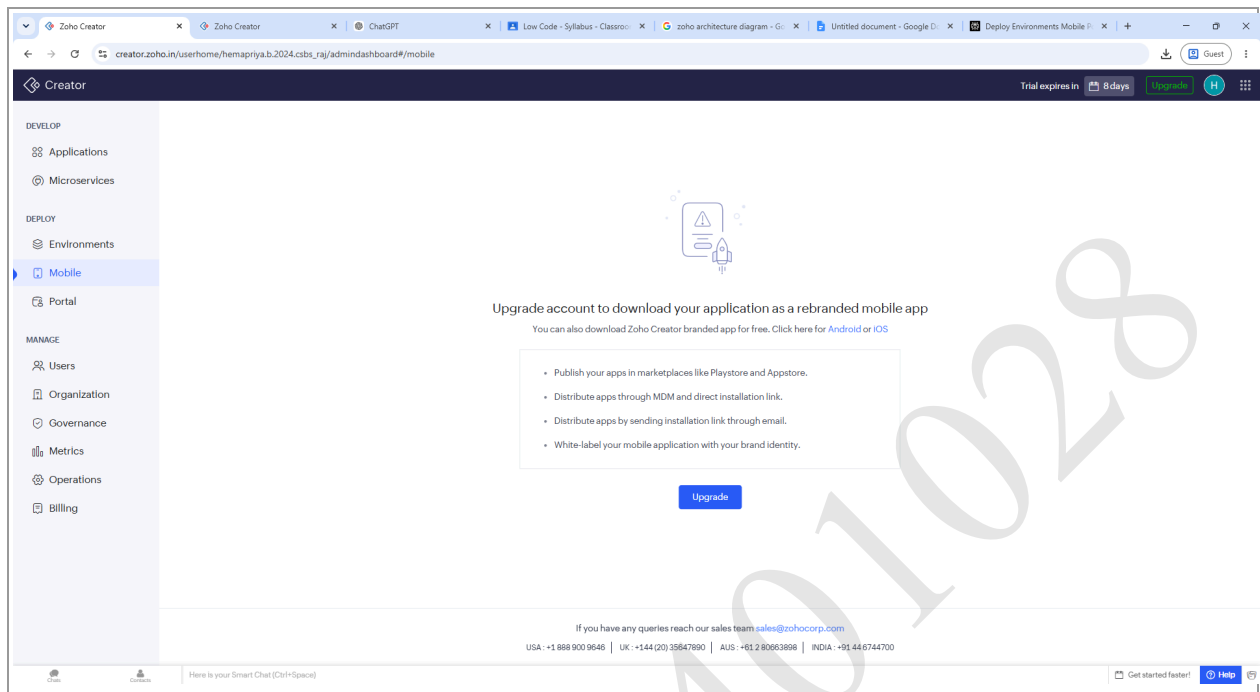


Figure 4. Mobile app layout and configuration settings.

- Configures mobile app layouts, offline access, and push notifications.
- Previews how forms and reports render on phones and tablets.
- Sets mobile-specific permissions for device-based access control.
- Enables field users and remote teams to work without constant connectivity.
- Ensures consistent, secure mobile experience across all devices.

5. Portal

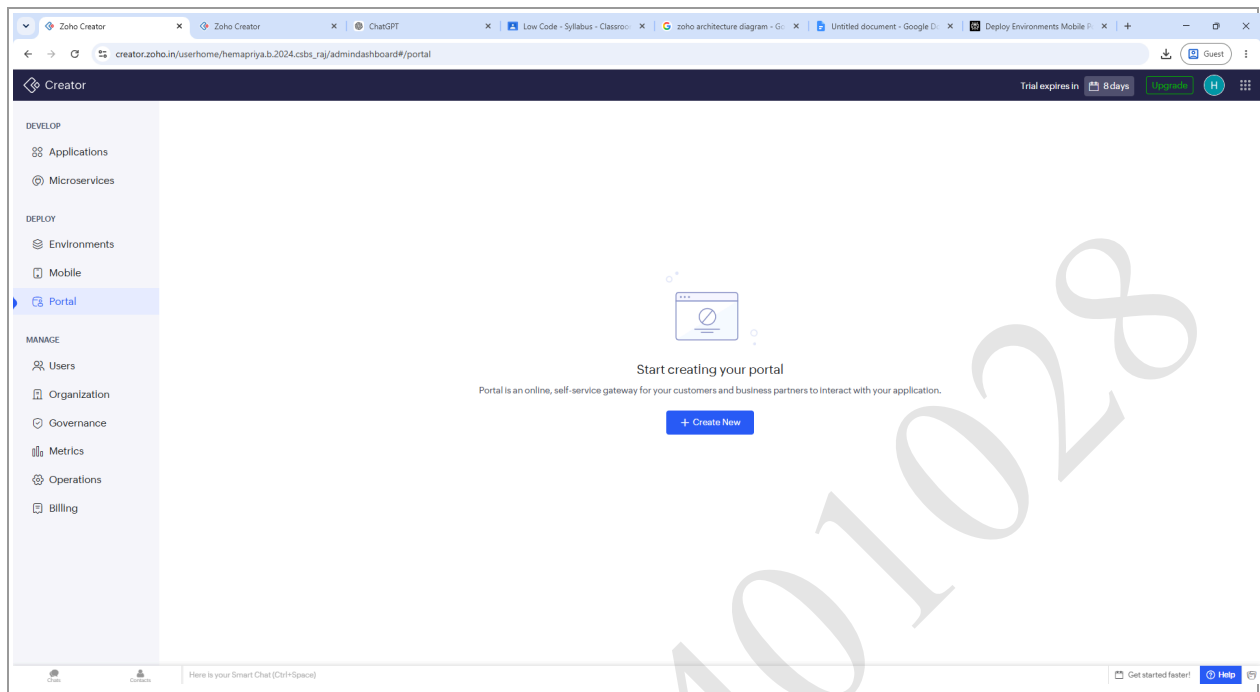


Figure 5. External-facing portal configuration.

- Builds external-facing portals for customers, partners, or vendors.
- Customizes branding, login methods, and visible app components.
- Groups portal users (agents, suppliers) with role-based access rights.
- Enables self-service actions like submitting requests or checking order status.
- Extends application reach beyond internal employees while maintaining security.

6. Users

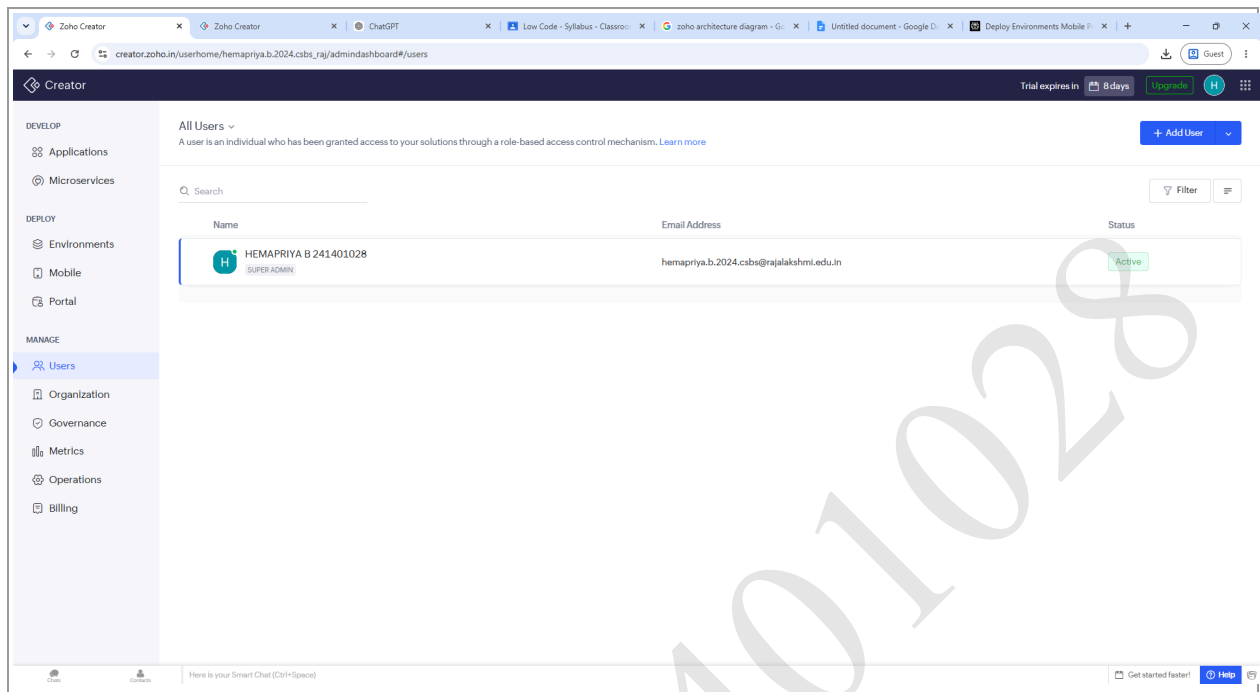


Figure 6. User management and access control.

- Manages internal users, external portal users, and public user access.
- Adds users manually or imports from directories with role-based permissions.
- Configures multi-factor authentication, IP restrictions, and session timeouts.
- Logs user activity for compliance and security audits.
- Ensures the right people have the right access at the right time.

7. Organization

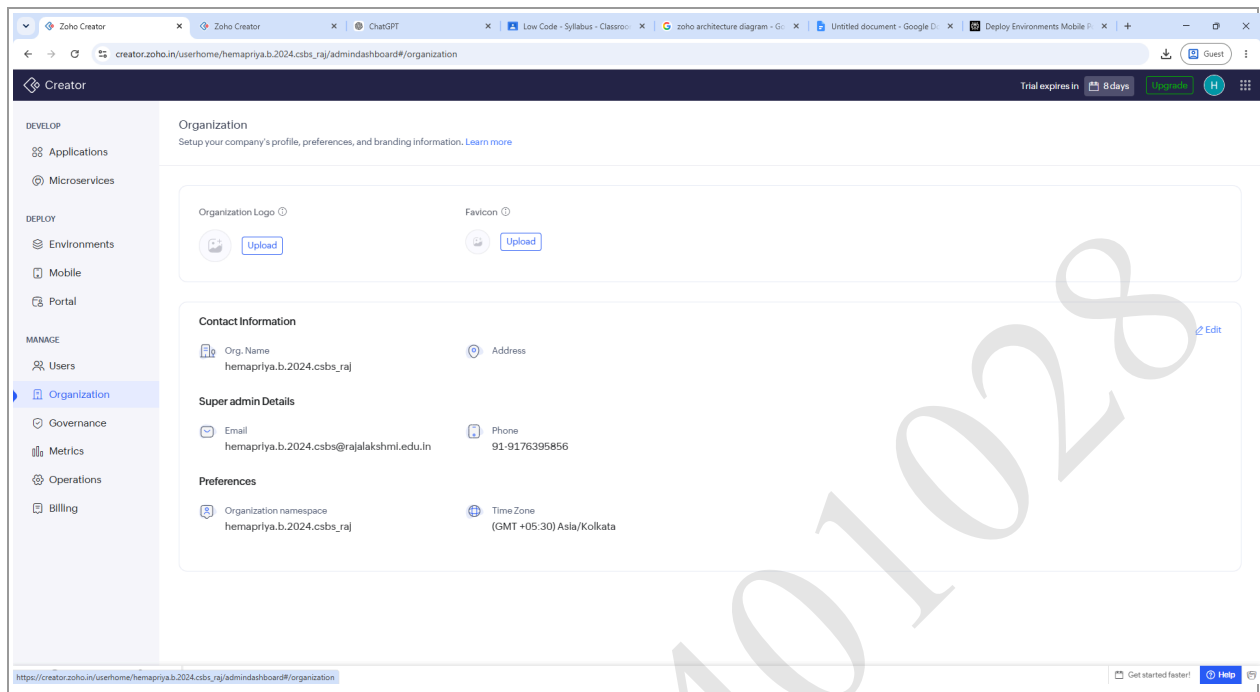


Figure 7. Organization structure and hierarchy settings.

- Defines company structure and hierarchy within Zoho Creator.
- Maps departments, teams, and reporting lines to enforce data visibility rules.
- Applies organization-wide policies for record-level access and data filtering.
- Syncs with Zoho Directory or other identity providers for centralized control.
- Aligns app behavior with the real-world org chart and security needs.

8. Governance

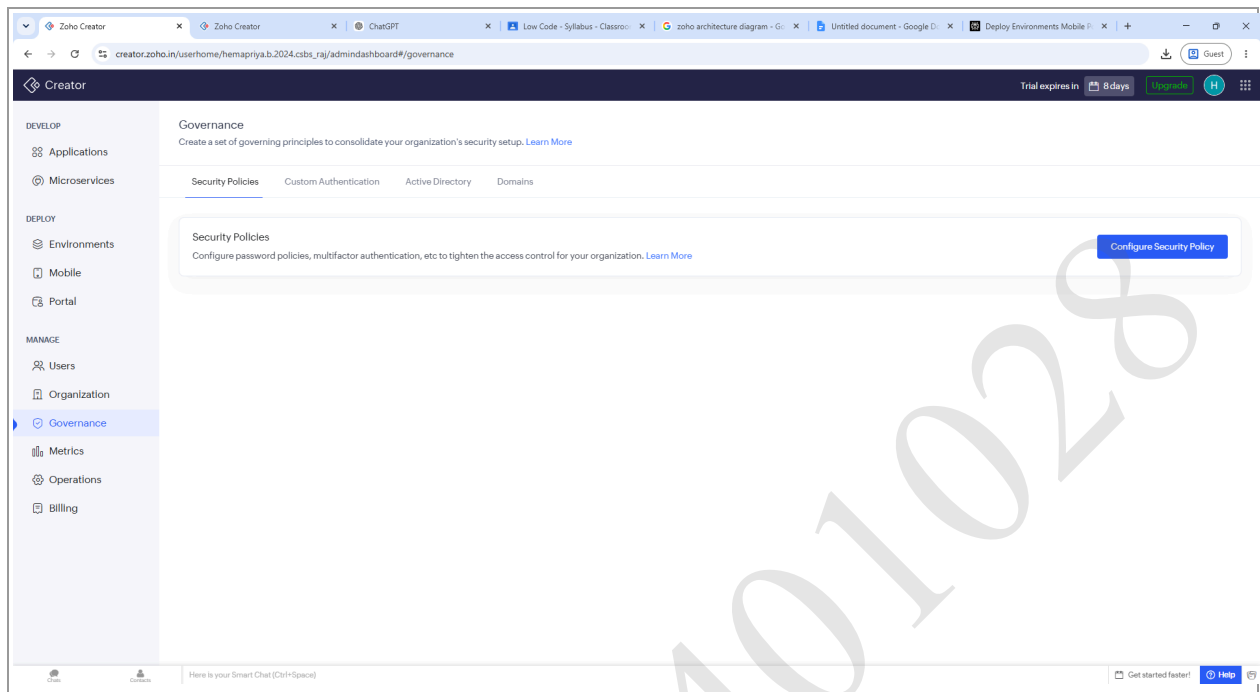


Figure 8. Governance and compliance controls.

- Enforces development and data policies across the workspace.
- Sets rules for app naming, data retention, and integration approvals.
- Runs compliance checks to flag risky configurations or unapproved scripts.
- Maintains audit trails for changes to apps, workflows, and user permissions.
- Maintains standards and reduces risk in enterprise deployments.

9. Metrics

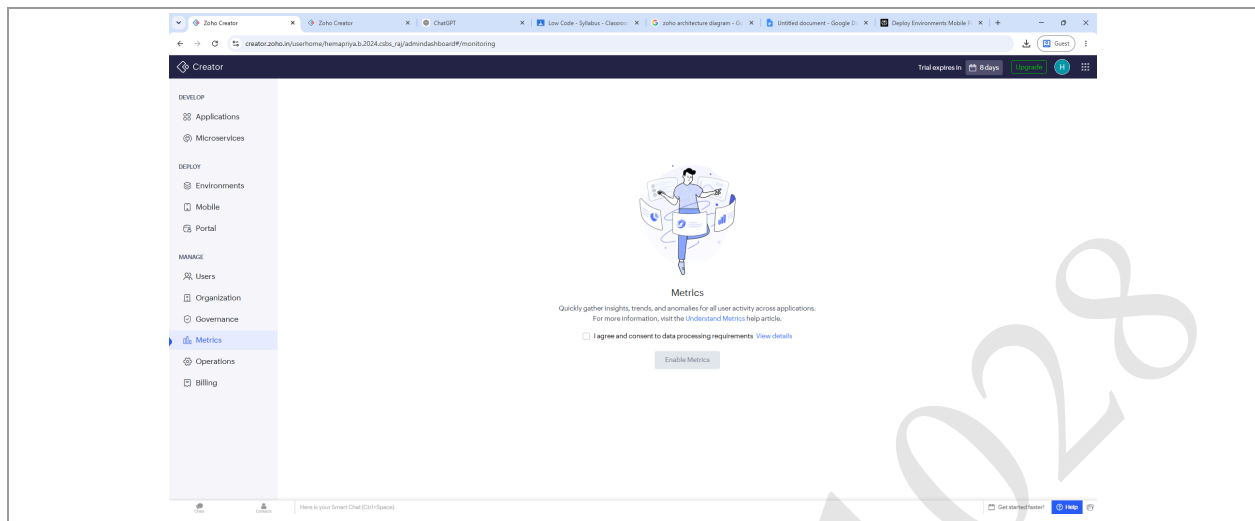


Figure 9. Usage statistics overview.

- Visualizes usage statistics for apps, users, and portals.
- Displays charts for form submissions, report views, and workflow executions.
- Filters data by date range, user group, or specific application components.
- Tracks portal user activity to show external engagement trends.
- Provides data to optimize performance and justify platform investments.

10. Operations

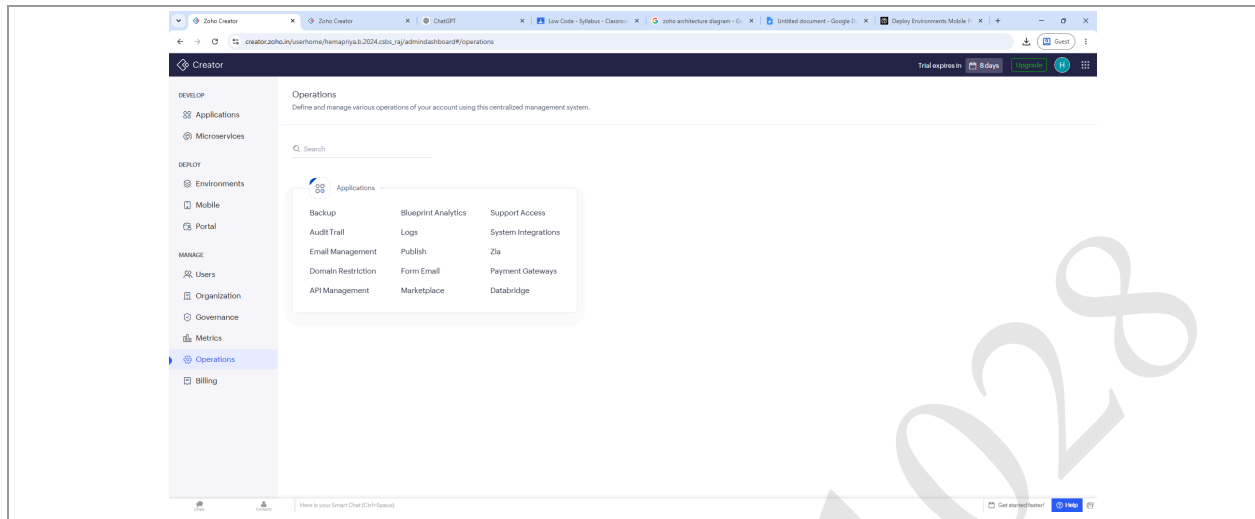


Figure 10. Form submissions and workflow executions.

- Monitors system health, integrations, and background jobs.
- Shows status of scheduled tasks, API connections, and data sync processes.
- Sends alerts for failures, throttling, or quota breaches.
- Allows restarting services or re-running failed workflows directly from this view.
- Keeps applications running smoothly and reduces manual troubleshooting.

11. Billing

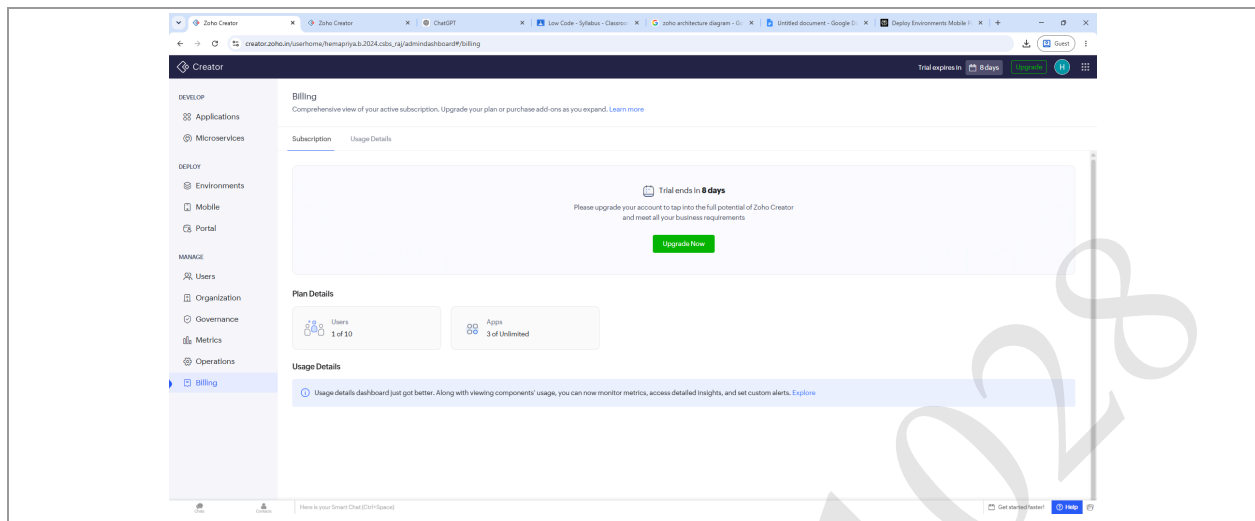


Figure 11. Portal user engagement trends.

- Manages Zoho Creator subscription and usage-based charges.
- Displays current plan details, add-on costs, and historical invoices.
- Enables upgrading/downgrading tiers, adding user licenses, or adjusting storage limits.
- Shows usage meters for apps, records, and API calls against quotas.
- Provides transparency and control over platform spending.